



Normanhurst Boys High School

2025

English Extension I

Trial HSC Examination | Assessment Block 3

General Instructions

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write using a blue or a black pen only
- Additional writing paper is available

Total marks: 50

Section I – 25 marks

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 1 hour for this section
- Use the writing booklet provided for this section

Section II – 25 marks

- Attempt Question 2
- Allow about 1 hour for this section
- Use the writing booklet provided for this section

Section I – Common Module: Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer Question 1 in the writing booklet provided. Ensure that your student number and this section is clearly labelled on the booklet. Additional writing paper is available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
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In your response to Question 1, draw on your understanding of the module Literary Worlds and the extract provided.

Text 1 – Nonfiction Extract

Worldbuilding, to me, transcends the mere construction of a setting—it's one of the defining pillars of storytelling that influences every facet of the narrative. At its core, worldbuilding is not just about placing characters in a constructed environment; it's about shaping a Literary World that is as intricate, dynamic, and complex as the human experience itself. It is the very architecture of the fictional world that determines how the characters interact with it, how the concerns of the story unfold, and how the narrative itself takes shape. In many ways, the world becomes a co-author—it's not simply a backdrop for action, but an active participant that moulds the story.

Moreover, worldbuilding allows the writer to craft the very fabric of the world itself with style and purpose. It's about making the world an active agent, imbued with significance, enriching the story with layers of meaning and symbolism.

World, Character, and Narrative.

Victor Shklovsky

Question 1 (25 marks)

Compose an imaginative, discursive, or hybridised response that explores the ways in which worldbuilding can offer insight into the experiences of others.

Enrich your response 'with layers of meaning' through the use of symbolism.

Section II – Elective: Worlds of Upheaval

25 marks

Attempt Question 2

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Answer Question 2 in the writing booklet provided. Ensure that your student number and this section is clearly labelled on the booklet. Additional writing paper is available.

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Worlds of Upheaval
 - craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question, demonstrating control of the use of language
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Question 2 (25 marks)

Read the stimulus provided below.

Evaluate how the ideas of the stimulus extend your understanding of the texts you have studied in Worlds of Upheaval.

In your response, make detailed reference to TWO prescribed texts and ONE other text of your own choosing.

Literature plays a crucial role in channelling social and political upheaval by engaging with the cultural, ideological, and emotional tensions of its time. It acts as a powerful vehicle for reflecting societal struggles, often shedding light on issues of inequality, power, and injustice. From a theoretical perspective, literature functions as a form of cultural discourse, where the written word both interrogates and challenges the prevailing norms, values, and systems that govern society.

Through its exploration of human experiences, literature provides insight into the complexities of social conflict and offers a space for marginalised voices to be heard. It can expose contradictions within societal structures and provoke critical reflection, fostering awareness and dialogue about the forces that shape collective life. The narratives created within literature allow for the exploration of both personal and political realms, drawing connections between the individual's experiences and larger social movements.

As a form of cultural production, literature not only reflects but also actively participates in the transformation of society. By representing the struggles and aspirations of its time, literature has the potential to inspire change, challenge established power dynamics and encourage new ways of thinking. It engages the reader in questioning the status quo, ultimately helping to pave the way for social progress and political transformation.

Cultural Theory and Cultural Studies
Raymond Williams

The Elective: Worlds of Upheaval prescribed texts are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
 - Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
 - Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*

- **Poetry**
 - Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966-1996*
The prescribed poems are:
 - **Digging*
 - **The Strand at Lough Beg*
 - **Casualty*
 - **Funeral Rites*
 - *from *Whatever You Say Say Nothing*
 - **Triptych*

- **Drama**
 - Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*

- **Film**
 - Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

End of Examination